THE COMMIT BOOK

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For families holding one or more offers. Rules checked 2026-11-05 against the 2026-27 NCAA
Division I Manual.
Edition 2026-27 · Rules checked 2026-11-05 · Education, not legal advice. No outcome promised.
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> Education, not legal advice. Nothing here promises an offer, aid, a roster spot, playing time or income. Confirm every rule with each school's compliance office. `TO VERIFY` = not confirmed against a primary source on 2026-11-05.

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1. VERBAL VS WRITTEN

A verbal offer or commitment binds neither side. Only a signed athletics aid agreement or settlement-related benefits agreement does (D1 Bylaw 13.02.13.1).

2. WRITTEN OFFERS

SPORT	EARLIEST WRITTEN OFFER	RULE
Football	Nov 15 of senior year (2028-11-15)	13.9.3.3
All other sports	Aug 1 of senior year (2028-08-01)	13.9.3.1
At a college's camp	Never during the camp	13.12.1.5

3. SIGNING PERIODS, CLASS OF 2029 (ALL `PROJECTED`: CALCULATED FROM CURRENT BYLAWS, NOT YET PUBLISHED)

SPORT	RULE TEXT	PROJECTED DATE
Basketball early	2nd Wednesday (7 a.m.) in Nov through following Wednesday	2028-11-08 to 11-15 — 13.02.13.1(a)
Basketball regular	Wednesday a week after the NCAA championships	April 2029, `TO VERIFY` once championship dates are set — 13.02.13.1(b)
Football early	Wednesday before the first Saturday in Dec through Friday	2028-11-29 to 12-01 — 13.02.13.1(c)
Football regular	First Wednesday in Feb	2029-02-07 — 13.02.13.1(e)
All other sports	2nd Wednesday in Nov	2028-11-08 — 13.02.13.1(f)

Each school sets its final signing date. In basketball and football, signing one of the two agreements in the early period still lets you sign the other with the same school later (13.02.13.1.2, adopted 10/8/25).

4. WHAT SIGNING DOES

Signing generally ends other schools' recruiting of you and lets the school publicize your commitment (Bylaw 13.10.2). Before signing, the school may only confirm it is recruiting you (13.10.1.1).

5. OFFER COMPARISON SHEET

ITEM	OFFER 1	OFFER 2	OFFER 3	OFFER 4
School / division				
Aid $/yr (written)				
Years guaranteed				
Settlement benefits (written)				
Cost of attendance				
Net cost/yr				
Roster count at my position (cap under 17.2)				
Major available				
If head coach leaves?				
Offer expires				

6. COMPLIANCE QUESTIONS

- Is this aid one year or multi-year, and renewable on what terms?
- Can aid be reduced for athletic reasons?
- Am I counted under the Bylaw 17.2 roster limit?
- What is in the settlement-related benefits agreement, and who pays it?
- What happens if I'm injured?

7. SOURCES

- 2026-27 NCAA D1 Manual, LSDBi 90008, checked 2026-11-05: Bylaws 13.02.13.1 (adopted 10/9/24, rev. 3/12/25, 10/8/25), 13.02.13.1.2, 13.9.3.1, 13.9.3.3, 13.10.1.1, 13.10.2, 13.12.1.5, 17.2.
- Projected dates computed 2026-11-05 from the bylaw formulas.